

Proposal for Vertex Financial Services Integrated Advertising Campaign

Executive Summary

Apex Creative Partners is pleased to submit this proposal in response to the RFP for the Vertex Financial Services Advertising Campaign. We recognize the unique challenges of the highly seasonal tax industry and the critical need to guide consumers through periods of confusion with authoritative messaging. Our approach leverages data-driven insights to reach the "Sensible Optimist" audience, specifically targeting the 35-44 demographic and mobile-first users to drive a 2.2% relative lift in brand consideration.

Agency Profile

With over 15 years of experience in seasonal retail and financial services, our agency specializes in rapid-scale campaigns. We have a proven track record of managing high-volume budgets in short windows, mirroring Apex's concentrated spend between January and April. Our expertise in multicultural (USM) segments has historically delivered CPAs significantly lower than general market averages.

Strategic Approach: Reaching the "Sensible Optimist"

Our strategy centers on "Data-Driven Empathy." We will target the working-class saver and male audiences by positioning Vertex Financial Services as the steady hand in a fluctuating tax landscape.

- Audience Segmentation: We will utilize Brand and Generic Custom Intent audiences to capture users the moment they begin searching for tax preparation products.
- Behavioral Targeting: High-priority focus on the 35-44 age group, which has shown a 7.9% historical relative lift.
- Contextual Relevance: Aligning messaging with current tax law changes to address consumer confusion directly.

Media Plan: Digital-First & Mobile-Optimized

Given that 91% of the target reach is achieved on mobile and tablet devices, our media plan is built for small screens.

Channel Mix & Tactics

Channel	Tactic	Objective
YouTube ▾	TrueView for Action	Drive conversions and appointments.
YouTube ▾	6s Bumper Ads	High-frequency reach and brand recall.
Search ▾	Generic Tax Intent	Capture active searchers during peak windows.

- **Bidding Strategy:** We will implement "Target CPA" (tCPA) bidding to maximize conversion volume while maintaining efficiency.
- **Creative Assets:** Video content will be optimized for a 98% sound-on benchmark to ensure high impact and audibility.
- **Conversion Optimization:** Every ad will feature "Sitelinks for Action," including "Make an Appointment" and "Upfront Pricing" to lower overall CPAs.

Measurement & Optimization Plan

We are committed to meeting and exceeding the historical performance benchmarks.

- **KPI Tracking:** We will target a Cost Per Lifted User (CPLU) of \$0.81 and a unique reach of over 11 million users.
- **Brand Lift Studies:** Continuous monitoring of awareness and consideration lift via Google Brand Lift surveys.
- **Performance Optimization:** Underperforming assets (those with CPAs significantly higher than the average) will be paused within 48 hours of detection.

Proposed Budget Allocation

Category	Allocation	Note
Digital Video (YouTube)	60%	Primary driver for reach and consideration.
Performance Search	25%	Capturing high-intent "Tax Prep" queries.
Multicultural (USM)	15%	Targeting efficient retail CPA segments.

Campaign Timeline

We are prepared to meet the accelerated timeline required for a successful mid-December launch.

- **Proposal Submission:**

 Date
- **Strategy Finalization:** June 15, 2026
- **Creative Production:** July - October 2026
- **Campaign Launch:** December 15, 2026

Submitted By:

 Person

Apex Creative Partners